INDIA INSIGHT LAB · STATE REPORTS

State Data Profile — Maharashtra

A sample state profile — every India Insight Lab state report follows this same structure.

7	39	18	1951–2036
CHAPTERS	INDICATORS	WITH STATE DATA	PERIOD COVERED

Generated 21 Aug 2026 · assembled from 33 sources

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report assembles 39 indicators across 7 chapters, drawn from 33 sources and covering 1951–2036.

Of those indicators, 18 carry state-level detail and can be mapped across India's states. The remaining 21 are published at national level only by their source, and are shown here as national series without a sub-national breakdown.

> **Coverage limits.** This report contains no district- or city-level figures. Comparable district data is not currently integrated into India Insight Lab, and no value here has been estimated, interpolated or carried down from a higher geography to fill that gap. Where a number is absent, it is absent.

KEY FINDINGS

Each finding below is computed directly from the state values in this report — the highest and lowest recorded state for that indicator. None are authored interpretations.

1 **Literacy rate by state**

Ranges from 94.0% in Kerala to 61.8% in Bihar — a spread of 32.2% across the 26 states reported.

Census of India 2011

2 **Multidimensional poverty by state**

Ranges from 33.76% in Bihar to 0.55% in Kerala — a spread of 33.21% across the 25 states reported.

NITI Aayog National MPI — A Progress Review 2023

3 **Slum population share by state**

Ranges from 24.0% in Andhra Pradesh to 4.9% in Kerala — a spread of 19.1% across the 15 states reported.

Census of India 2011, Primary Census Abstract for Slum

CHAPTER 1

Population & demography

4 of 10 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

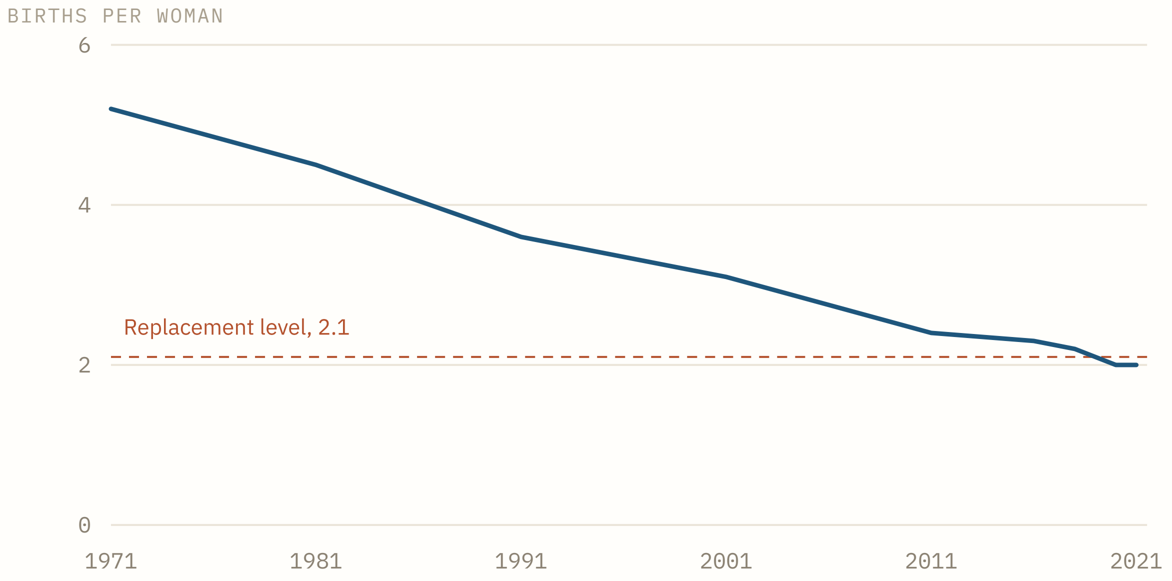
FIGURE 1.1 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 1.1

LINE CHART

Total fertility rate

Births per woman, national series. The dashed line marks the replacement level of 2.1.



Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI

The total fertility rate is the number of children a woman would bear if she experienced current age-specific fertility rates throughout her reproductive life. We splice decennial Census-based estimates to 1991 with the annual Sample Registration System thereafter; NFHS rounds are shown where they differ by more than 0.1.

Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI Coverage: 1971–2023 Updated: 18 Jul 2026

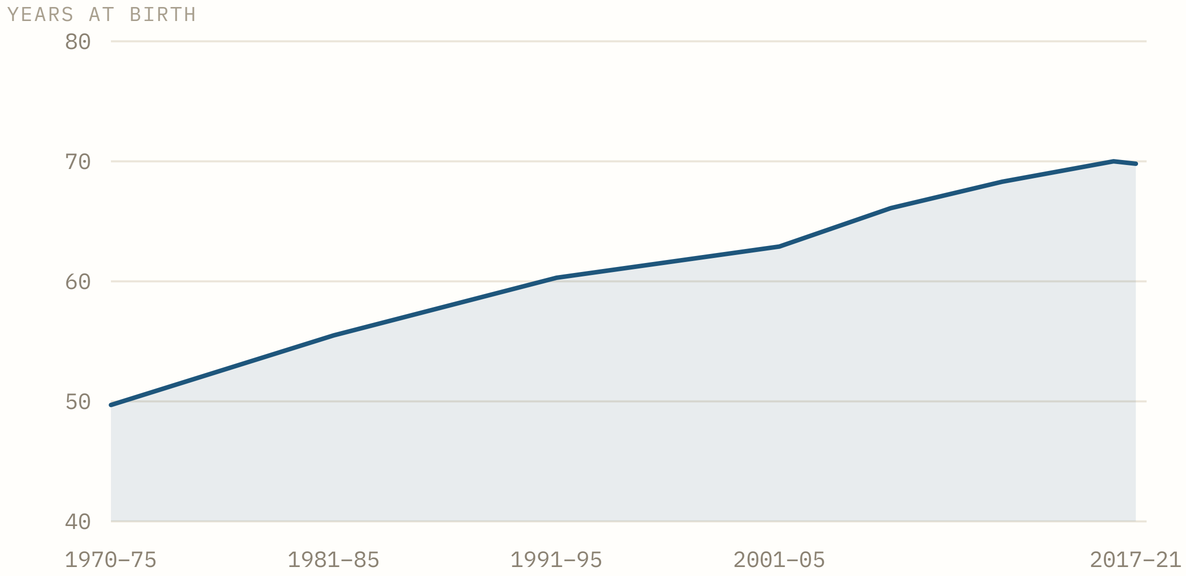
FIGURE 1.2 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 1.2

AREA CHART

Life expectancy at birth

Period life expectancy at birth, India, five-year SRS estimates.



Source: SRS Abridged Life Tables 2017–21, RGI

Period life expectancy at birth assumes a newborn experiences current mortality rates at every age for life. It is not a forecast of any individual cohort. The 2021 fall is real and reflects pandemic excess mortality; estimates of its size still vary across sources by several years.

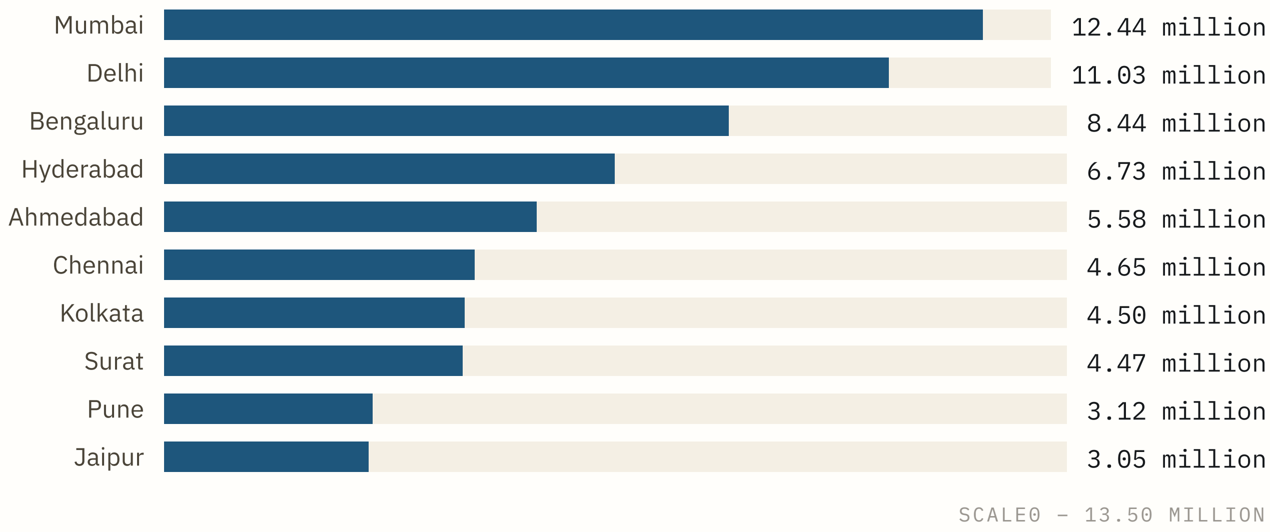
Source: SRS Abridged Life Tables 2017–21, RGI   Coverage: 1970–75 to 2017–21   Updated: 18 Jul 2026

FIGURE 1.3 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 1.3 RANKED BARS

Ten largest cities by population

Population within municipal limits (city proper), excluding the wider urban agglomeration.



> City-proper population, within municipal limits — smaller than the wider urban agglomeration. Delhi's urban agglomeration (16.3 million) is roughly 48% larger than the city figure shown here.

Source: Census of India 2011

City-proper population excludes adjoining outgrowths and satellite towns, so it understates real metropolitan size — Delhi's urban agglomeration (16.3 million) is roughly 48% larger than its city-proper figure. We use city-proper because it is the more consistently defined boundary across cities.

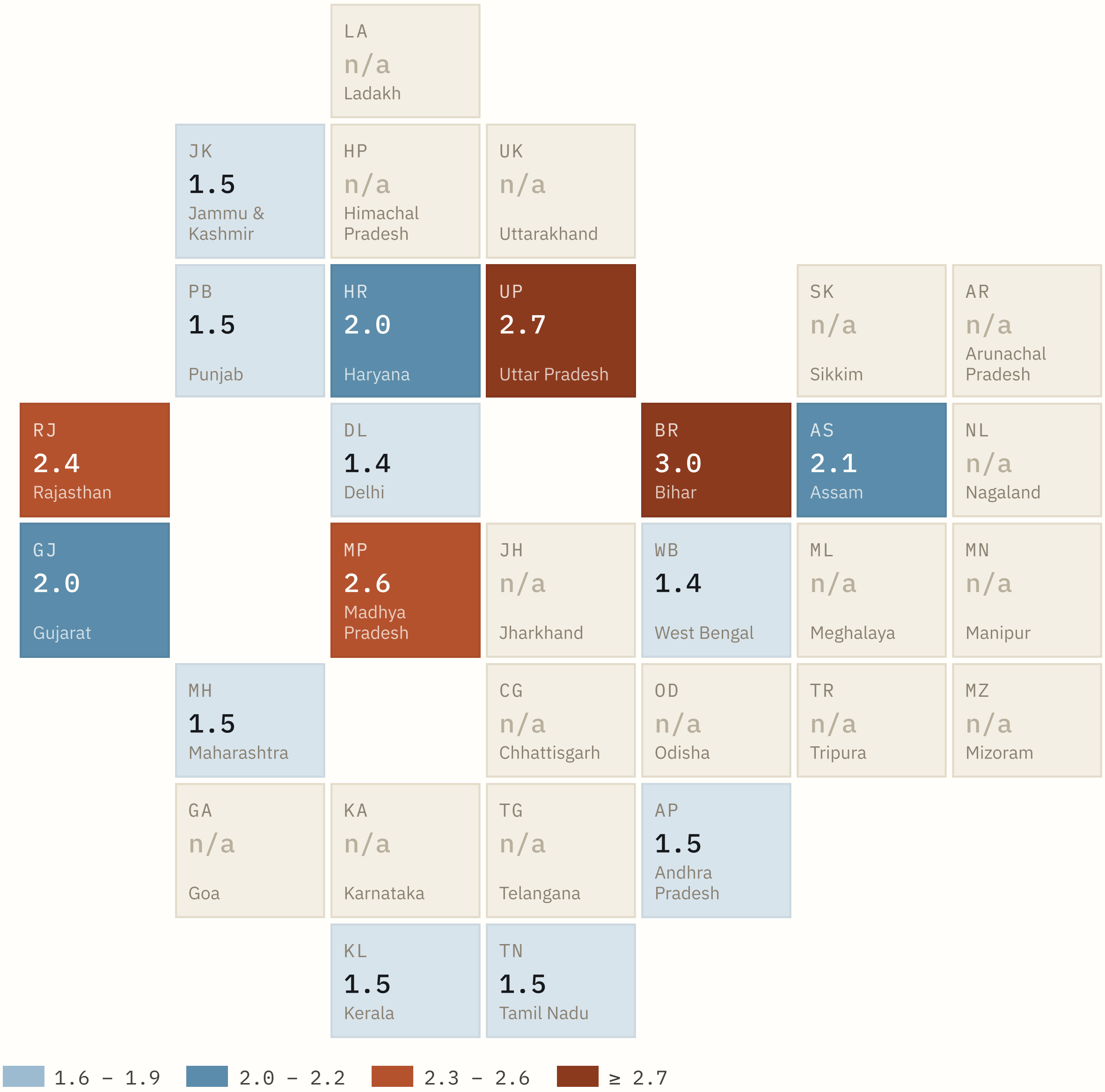
Source: Census of India 2011 Coverage: 2011 Updated: 16 Aug 2026

FIGURE 1.4 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 1.4 TILE MAP

Fertility rate — tile map

One equal-area tile per State and UT, positioned to approximate relative geography.



> Schematic tile map: one tile per State / UT, positioned to approximate relative geography. Tiles are equal-area, so no state is visually over-weighted by land mass.

Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI

A tile map removes the visual bias of land area: Rajasthan does not shout louder than Kerala. Tiles marked n/a are States and UTs for which the SRS 2021 report does not publish a separate TFR estimate.

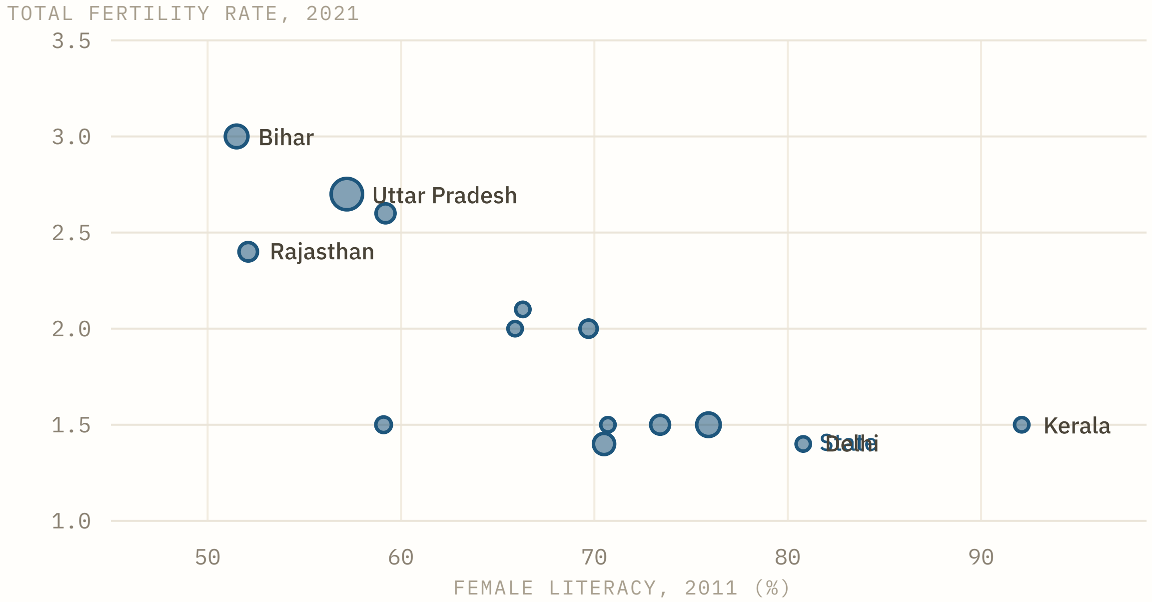
Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI Coverage: 2021 Updated: 18 Jul 2026

FIGURE 1.5 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 1.5 SCATTER

Female literacy against fertility

Each circle is a State. Horizontal: female literacy, 2011. Vertical: TFR, 2021.
Area: population.



> Circle area is population. The relationship is strong and negative, but it is not proof of causation: literacy, age at marriage, child mortality and household income all move together.

Source: Census of India 2011; SRS 2021, RGI

The negative relationship is strong across States, but it is not evidence of causation on its own — literacy, age at marriage, child mortality and household income all move together. Read it as a description of the fertility map, not a mechanism.

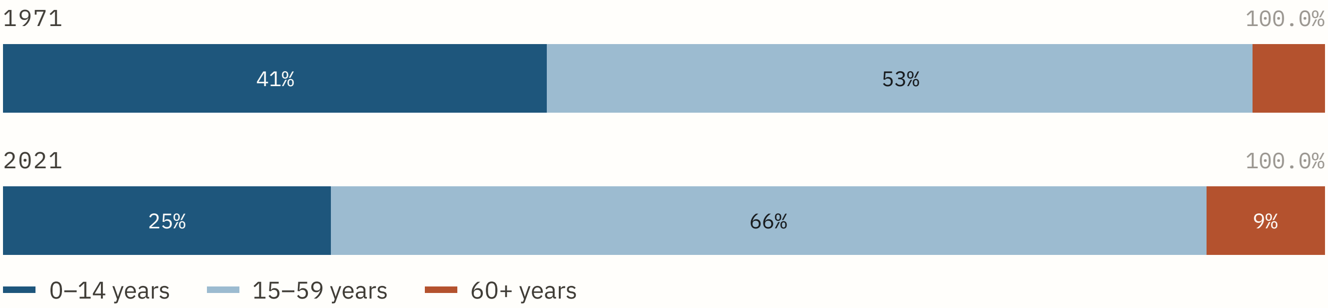
Source: Census of India 2011; SRS 2021, RGI   Coverage: 2011 / 2021   Updated: 18 Jul 2026

FIGURE 1.6 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 1.6 COMPOSITION

Age composition of the population

Share of the population in three broad age groups, fifty years apart.



> The working-age share has risen 12.8 points in fifty years — the demographic dividend — while the 60+ share has not yet doubled. It does so in the next twenty-five years.

Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI

The 0–14 share fell from 41.2% to 24.8% between 1971 and 2021 while the working-age share rose to 66.2%. That gap is the demographic dividend; it closes as the 60+ share, now 9.0%, roughly doubles by 2050.

Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI Coverage: 1971 and 2021 Updated: 18 Jul 2026

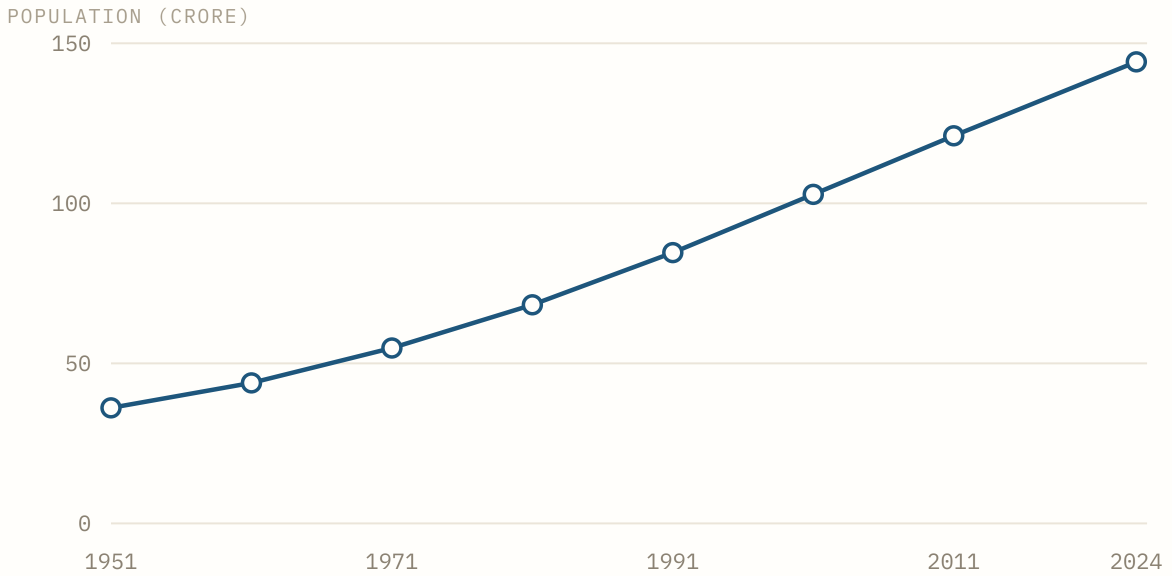
FIGURE 1.7 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 1.7

LINE CHART

Total population and density

India's total population by decade, alongside population density.



> Density has risen in lockstep, from 117 persons/km² in 1951 to 382 in the 2011 Census and an estimated 480 today — India adds roughly one Australia's worth of people every three years.

Source: Census of India; UN World Population Prospects

India crossed 1 billion people around 2000 and an estimated 1.44 billion by 2024, having overtaken China as the world's most populous country in 2023. Density figures assume a fixed land area, so they track population growth almost exactly.

Source: Census of India; UN World Population Prospects Coverage: 1951–2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

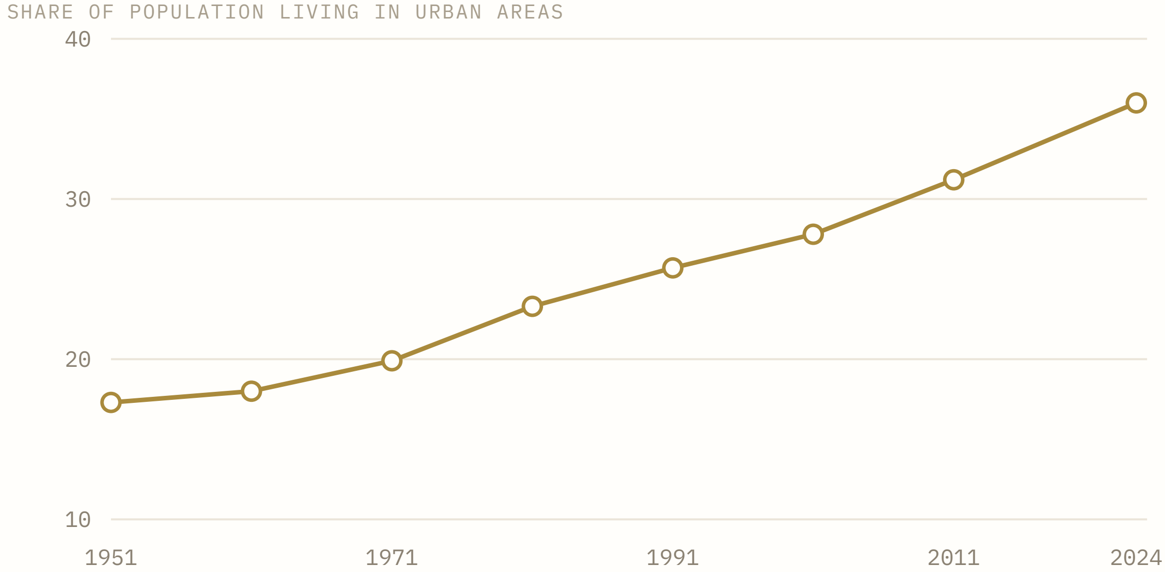
FIGURE 1.8 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 1.8

LINE CHART

Urbanisation rate

Share of India's population living in urban areas, by decade.



> India urbanised more slowly than China or Indonesia over the same decades, which is part of why its cities are now catching up under significant infrastructure strain. The 2024 figure is a UN estimate; the next Census will provide the first official update since 2011.

Source: Census of India; UN World Urbanization Prospects

India's urbanisation has been notably gradual compared to East Asian peers — a mixed blessing that avoided some of the informal-settlement crises seen elsewhere, but also means the next wave of urban growth, now underway, is arriving on infrastructure built for a smaller urban population.

Source: Census of India; UN World Urbanization Prospects Coverage: 1951–2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

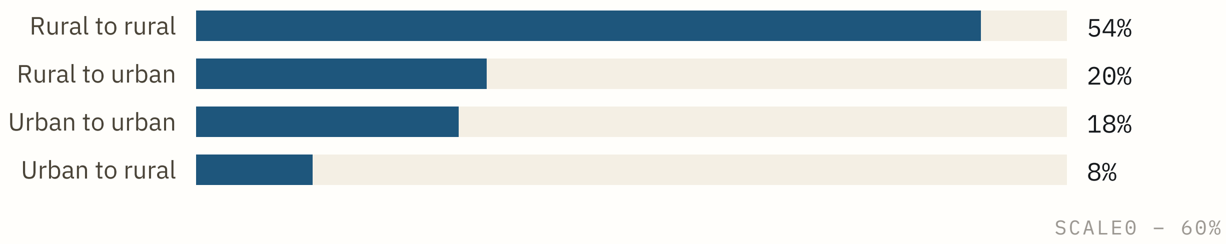
FIGURE 1.9 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 1.9

RANKED BARS

Internal migration streams

India’s internal migrants by origin-destination stream.



Source: Census of India, D-series migration tables

Rural-to-rural migration, mostly marriage-related moves by women, is the largest stream by volume — rural-to-urban labour migration, the stream most associated with India’s growth story, is actually the second largest, not the biggest.

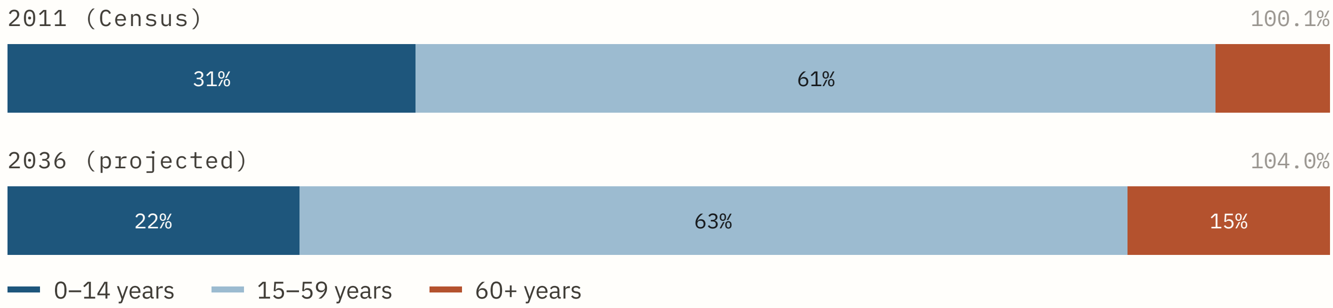
Source: Census of India, D-series migration tables Coverage: 2011 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 1.10 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 1.10 COMPOSITION

Future population by age group

Official government projection of India’s age structure through 2036.



> From the Registrar General’s official National Population Projections (2011–2036), not an ad hoc extrapolation. The 60+ share nearly doubles while the working-age share peaks and starts to plateau — the demographic dividend has a visible expiry date in this data.

Source: National Population Projections 2011–2036, Registrar General of India

This is RGI’s own published projection, not an extrapolation built for this site. It shows the demographic dividend has a visible expiry date: the working-age share is projected to plateau around the mid-2030s as the 60+ share nearly doubles from its 2011 level.

Source: National Population Projections 2011–2036, Registrar General of India

Coverage: 2011 to 2036 (projected) Updated: 18 Aug 2026

CHAPTER 2

Health & nutrition

3 of 4 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

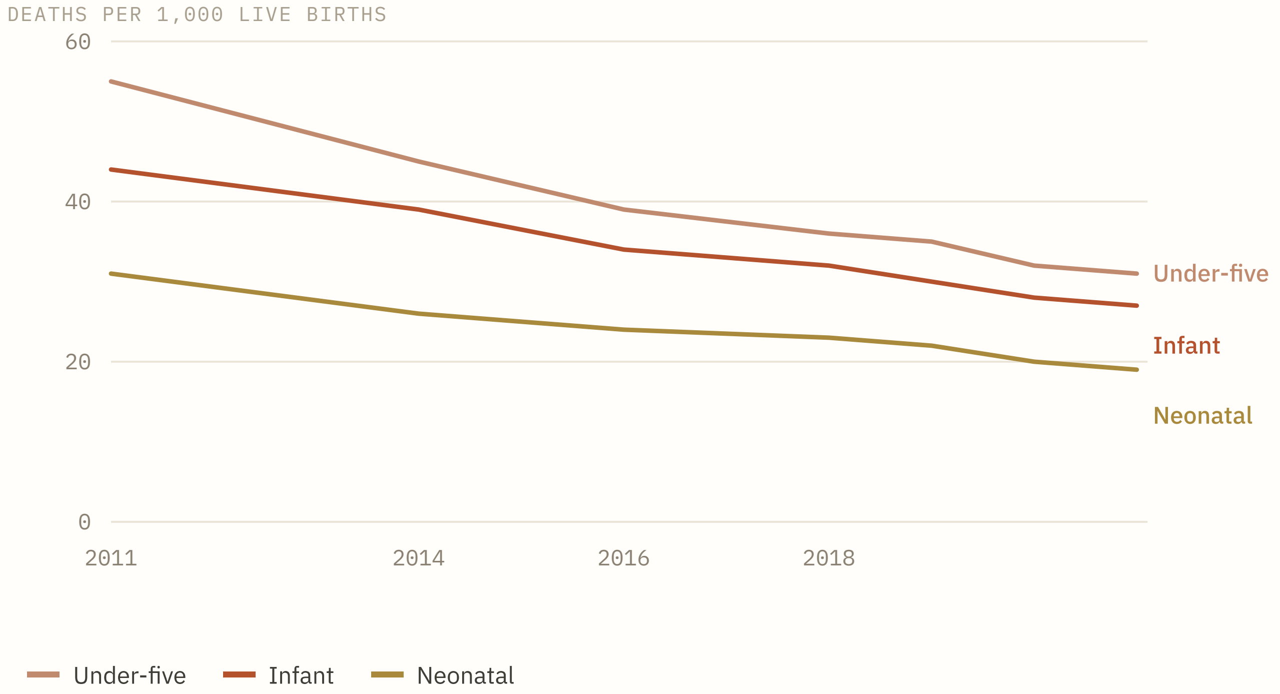
FIGURE 2.1 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 2.1

LINE CHART

Infant and under-five mortality

Deaths before age one and before age five, per 1,000 live births.



Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI

India accounted for roughly a fifth of global under-five deaths in 2022, down from a third in 1990. The decline is steepest in states that expanded institutional delivery fastest after 2005.

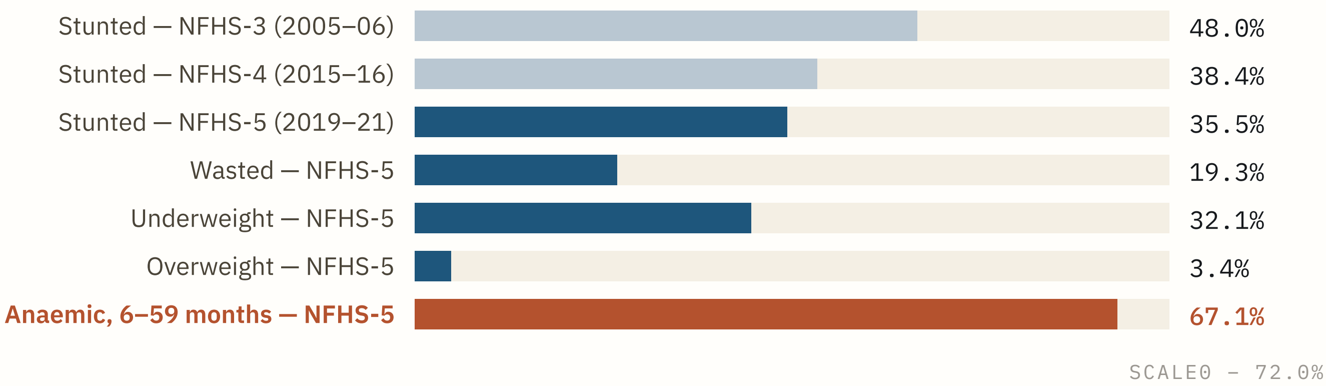
Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI   Coverage: 1990–2022   Updated: 02 Jun 2026

FIGURE 2.2 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 2.2 RANKED BARS

Child undernutrition and anaemia

Anthropometric failure among children under five, and anaemia prevalence.



> Anaemia prevalence rose between NFHS-4 (58.6%) and NFHS-5 (67.1%) even as stunting fell — partly a change in field haemoglobin measurement, partly real.

Source: NFHS-3, NFHS-4 and NFHS-5, IIPS

Stunting (low height-for-age) reflects chronic undernutrition; wasting (low weight-for-height) reflects acute deficits. Anaemia prevalence rose between NFHS-4 and NFHS-5 even as stunting fell — partly a measurement change, partly real.

Source: NFHS-3, NFHS-4 and NFHS-5, IIPS Coverage: 2005–2021 Updated: 02 Jun 2026

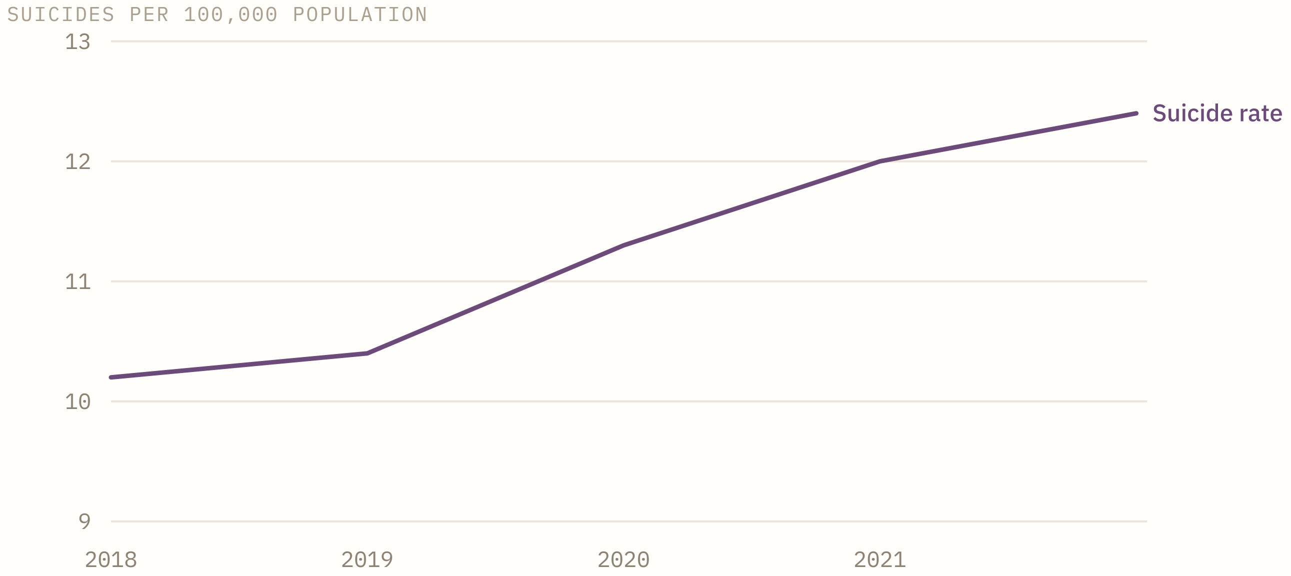
FIGURE 2.3 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 2.3

LINE CHART

Suicide rate

Reported suicides per 100,000 population, national annual rate.



NCRB’s Accidental Deaths & Suicides in India series relies on police-recorded cases; stigma-driven under-reporting affects the level, though the rising trend since 2018 is consistent across editions.

Source: NCRB, Accidental Deaths & Suicides in India

The rate has risen every year since 2018. NCRB figures are police-recorded cases; stigma and, until 2017, the criminal status of attempted suicide are known sources of under-reporting, so levels are likely understated even where the trend is real.

Source: NCRB, Accidental Deaths & Suicides in India   Coverage: 2018–2022   Updated: 18 Aug 2026

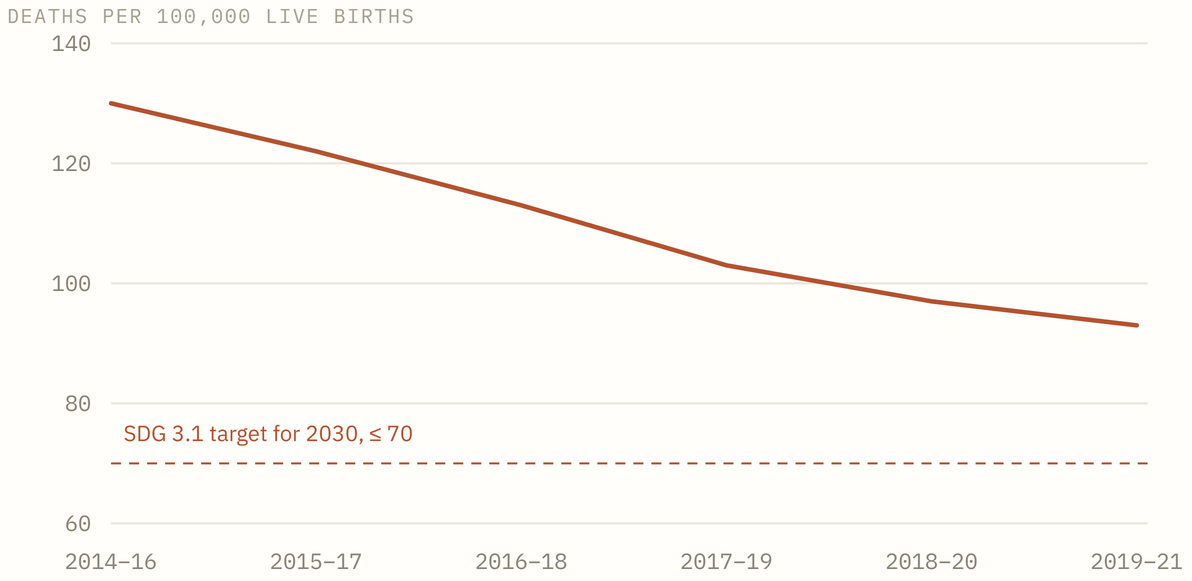
FIGURE 2.4 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 2.4

LINE CHART

Maternal mortality ratio

Three-year moving estimates against the SDG 3.1 target of 70.



Source: SRS Special Bulletin on Maternal Mortality, RGI

MMR fell from 130 in 2014–16 to 93 in 2019–21. Eight States have already met the SDG target; Assam, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and Bihar remain furthest from it.

Source: SRS Special Bulletin on Maternal Mortality, RGI Coverage: 2014–16 to 2019–21 Updated: 02 Jun 2026

CHAPTER 3

Education & literacy

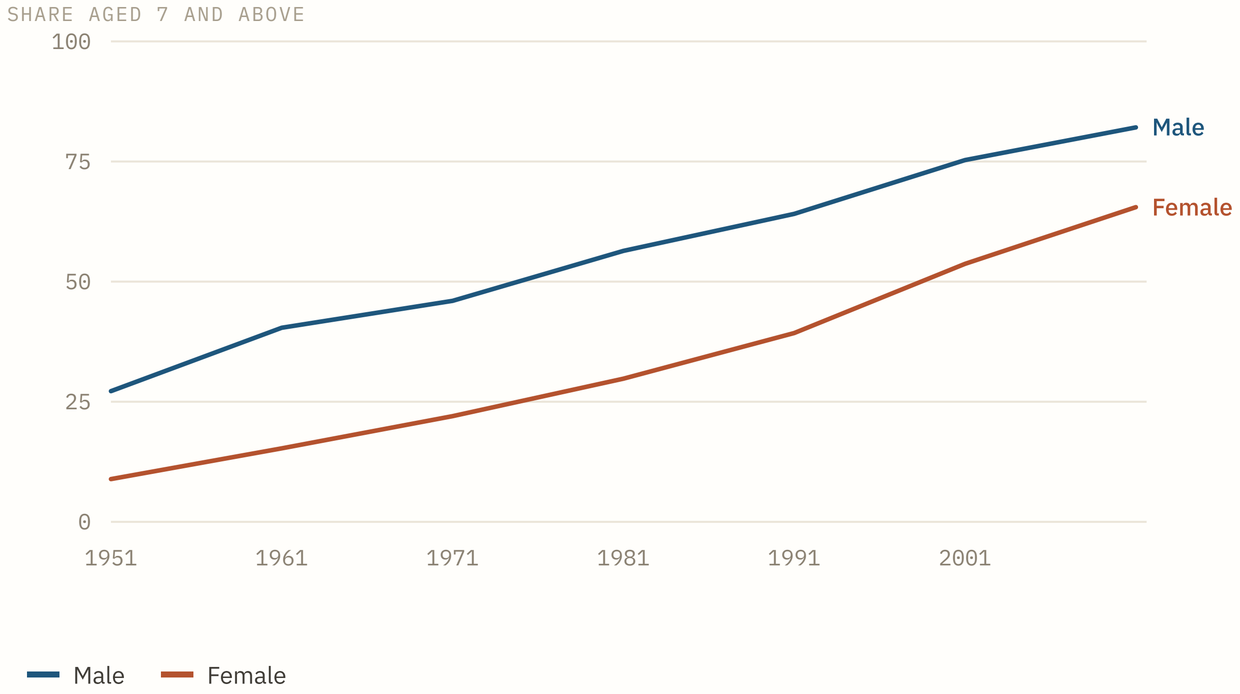
3 of 4 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 3.1 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 3.1 LINE CHART

Literacy rate by sex

Share of the population aged 7 and above able to read and write, by sex.



Source: Census of India

The Census definition — able to read and write with understanding in any language — is self-reported and generous. Survey-based functional literacy measures run 8–14 points lower. The series ends in 2011 because the 2021 Census was postponed.

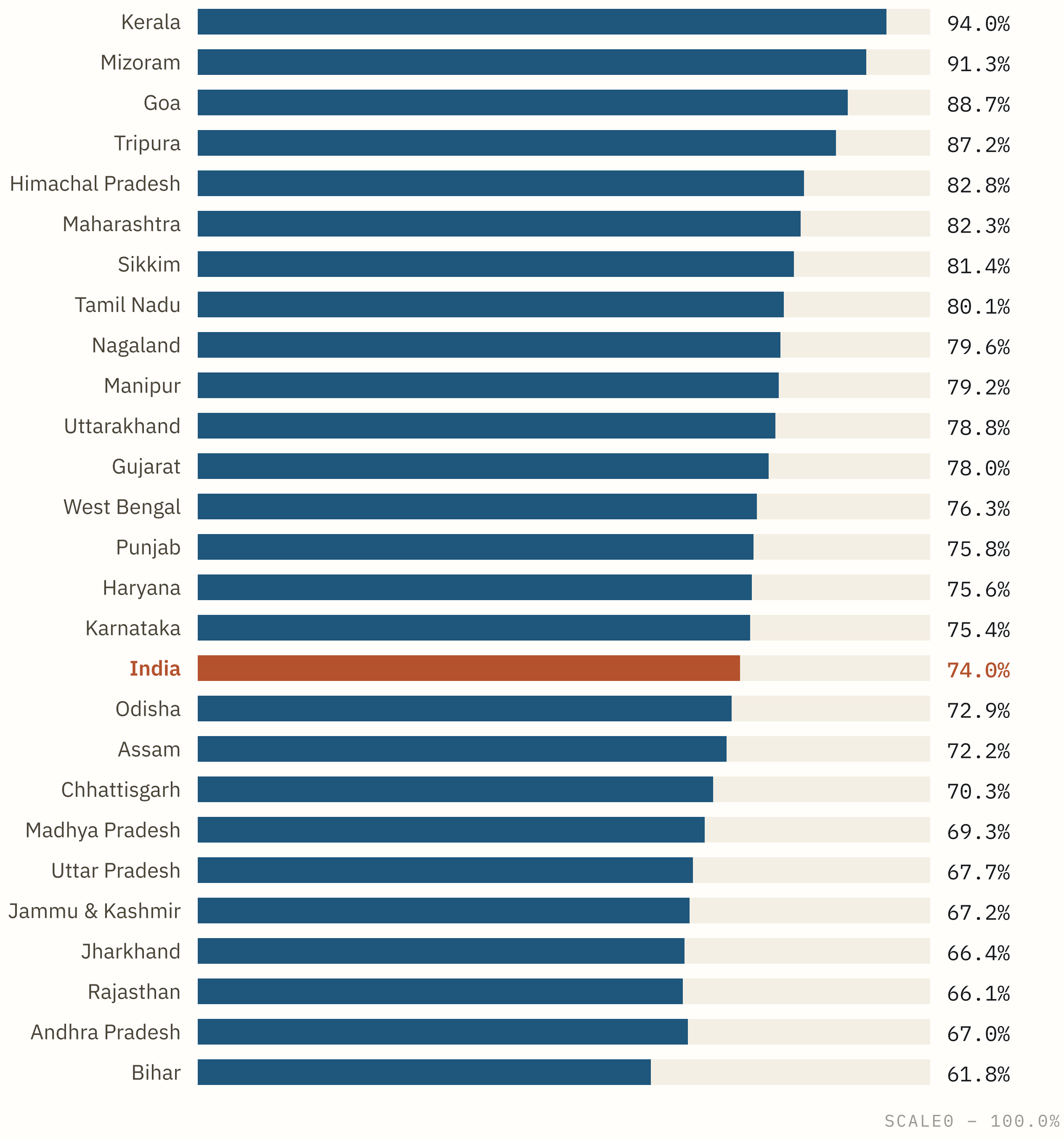
Source: Census of India Coverage: 1951–2011 Updated: 11 Jan 2026

FIGURE 3.2 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 3.2 RANKED BARS

Literacy rate by state

Census 2011 literacy rates. The national figure is shown in rust.



Source: Census of India 2011

Kerala has led every Census round since 1951. The bottom of the ranking has been more stable than the top: Bihar has been last or second-last in every round since 1961.

> Highest: **Kerala** at 94.0%. Lowest: **Bihar** at 61.8%.

Source: Census of India 2011 Coverage: 2011 Updated: 11 Jan 2026

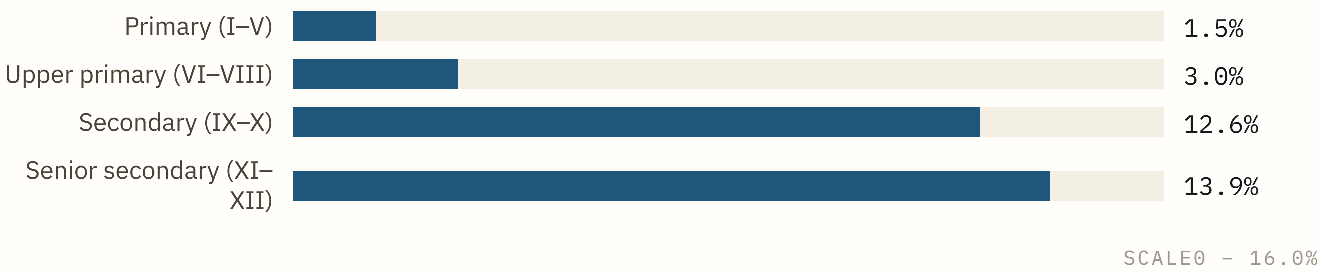
FIGURE 3.3 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 3.3

RANKED BARS

School dropout rate by level

Annual dropout rate by schooling stage, national average.



Source: UDISE+, Ministry of Education

Dropout is heavily concentrated at the secondary stage, roughly the age children are pulled into work or, for girls in some states, marriage. Primary-stage dropout is now low nationally, though state variation is much wider than the national figure suggests.

Source: UDISE+, Ministry of Education Coverage: 2021–22 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

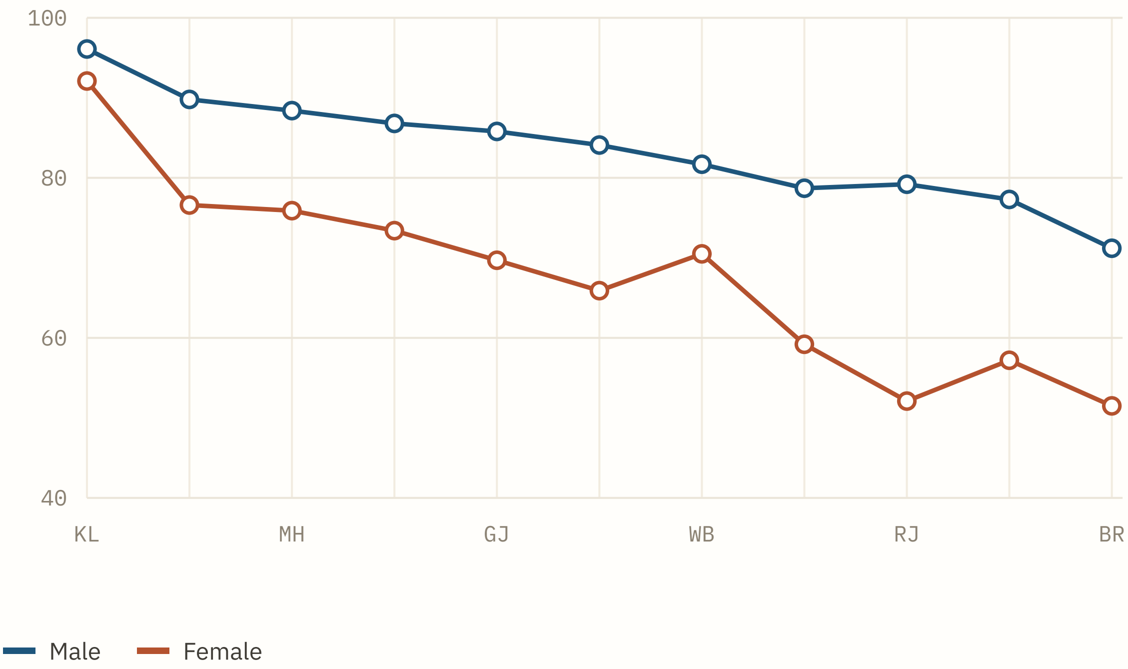
FIGURE 3.4 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 3.4

LINE CHART

Literacy gender gap by state

Male and female literacy in eleven States, ordered by male literacy. The vertical distance is the gap.



States ordered by male literacy. The vertical distance is the gender gap: 4 points in Kerala, 33 in Rajasthan.

Source: Census of India 2011

The gap is 4 points in Kerala and 33 in Rajasthan. States with high male literacy do not automatically have small gaps: West Bengal and Madhya Pradesh have similar male rates and very different female ones.

Source: Census of India 2011 Coverage: 2011 Updated: 11 Jan 2026

CHAPTER 4

Poverty & incomes

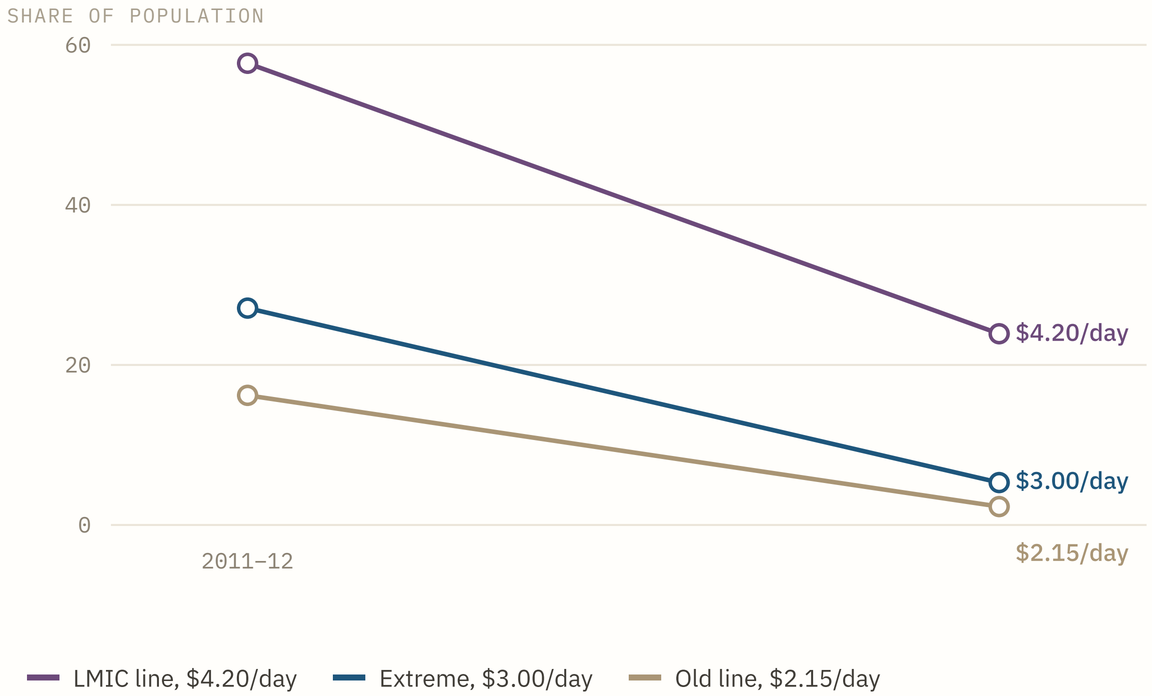
3 of 7 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 4.1 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 4.1 SLOPE CHART

Poverty headcount ratio

Two definitions: income below $2.15/day (2017 PPP) and the national multidimensional measure.



> A slope chart: two survey rounds, three poverty lines. The World Bank replaced the $2.15 (2017 PPP) line with $3.00 (2021 PPP) in 2025, which raises the measured rate without any change in living conditions.

Source: World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief, India (2025)

Income poverty and multidimensional poverty answer different questions. The MPI counts deprivations in nutrition, schooling, sanitation, fuel, housing and assets; a household can escape the income line while remaining multidimensionally poor, and often does.

Source: World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief, India (2025) Coverage: 1993–2022 Updated: 24 Jul 2026

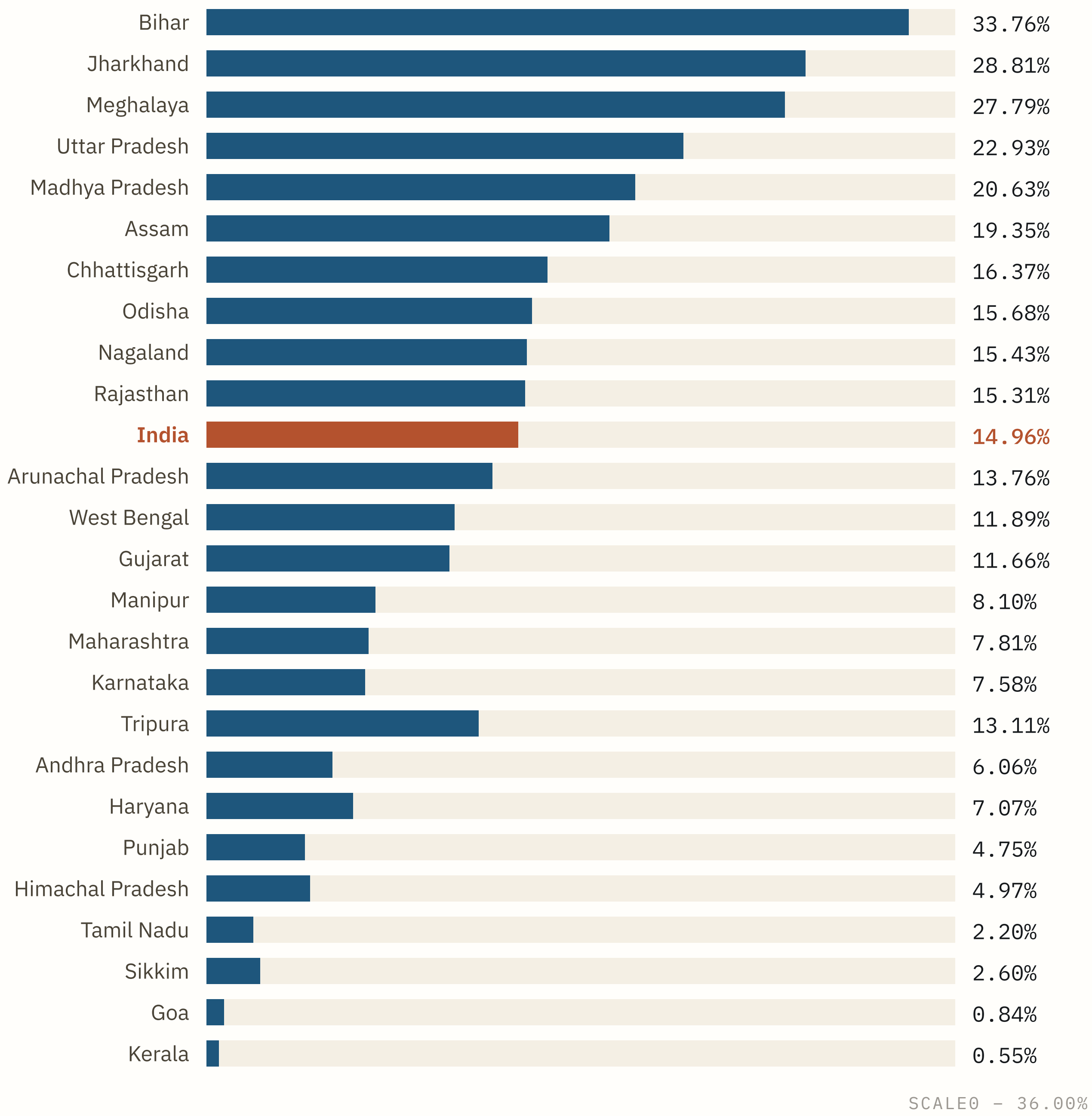
FIGURE 4.2 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 4.2

RANKED BARS

Multidimensional poverty by state

Share of the population identified as multidimensionally poor, NFHS-5 round.



Source: NITI Aayog National MPI — A Progress Review 2023

The National MPI uses twelve indicators across health, education and living standards. Bihar, Jharkhand and Uttar Pradesh together account for roughly half of India's multidimensionally poor population.

> Highest: **Bihar** at 33.76%. Lowest: **Kerala** at 0.55%.

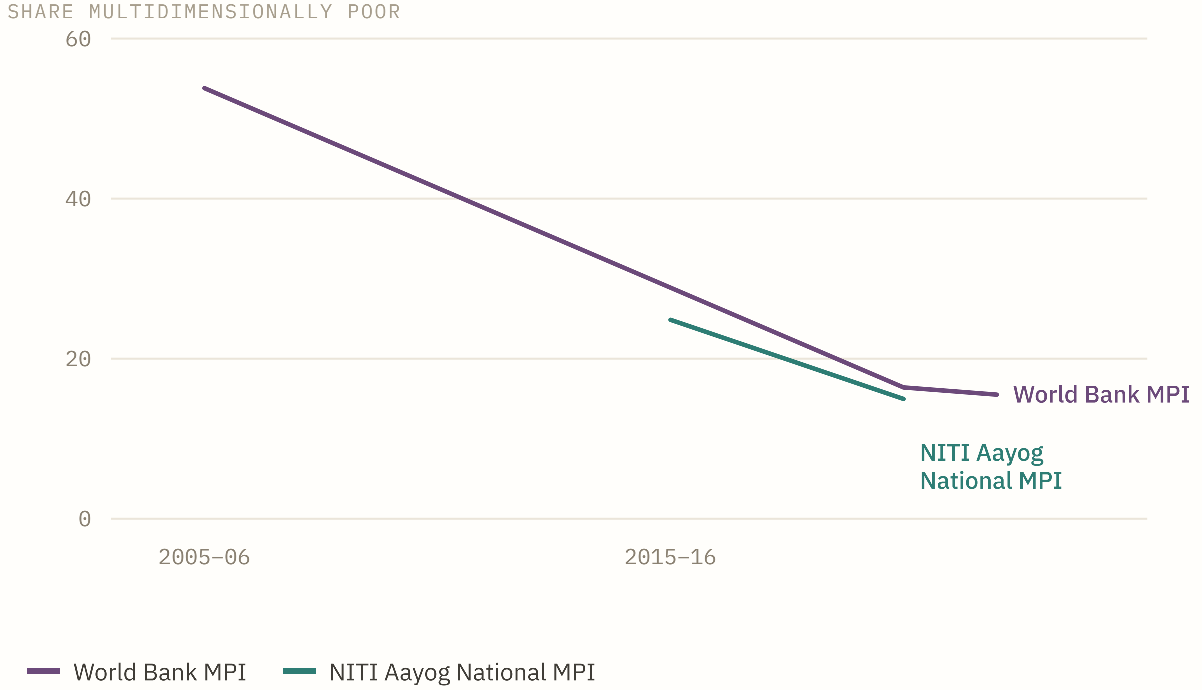
Source: NITI Aayog National MPI — A Progress Review 2023 Coverage: 2019–21 Updated: 24 Jul 2026

FIGURE 4.3 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 4.3 LINE CHART

Multidimensional poverty — two indices

The national index and the World Bank index, plotted together.



> Two indices, different baskets: the National MPI uses twelve indicators across health, education and living standards; the World Bank index excludes nutrition and health deprivation.

Source: NITI Aayog National MPI (2023); World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief (2025)

The two indices use different baskets — the National MPI counts twelve indicators including nutrition and maternal health, the World Bank version excludes them — so they should be read as bounds rather than as competing estimates of one quantity.

Source: NITI Aayog National MPI (2023); World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief (2025) Coverage: 2005–06 to 2022–23

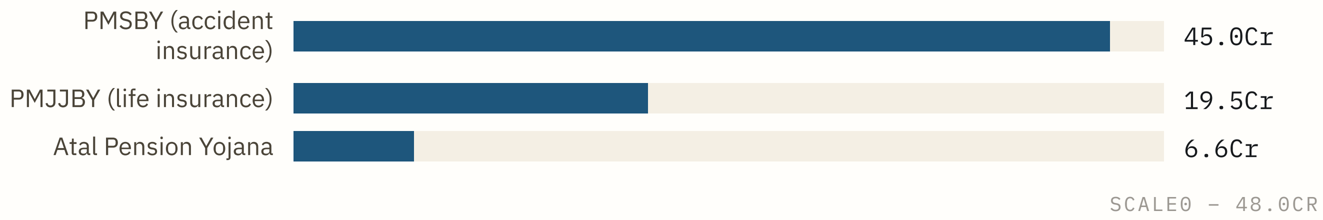
Updated: 24 Jul 2026

FIGURE 4.4 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 4.4 RANKED BARS

Jan Suraksha scheme enrolment

Cumulative enrolment in India’s three flagship social security schemes: accident insurance, life insurance and pension.



Source: Jan Suraksha schemes, Department of Financial Services

PMSBY’s low annual premium (₹20) drives far higher enrolment than the pension scheme, which requires a recurring contribution. Enrolment counts include lapsed and inactive accounts in most published figures, so active coverage is somewhat lower than these cumulative totals suggest.

Source: Jan Suraksha schemes, Department of Financial Services Coverage: Cumulative to 2024

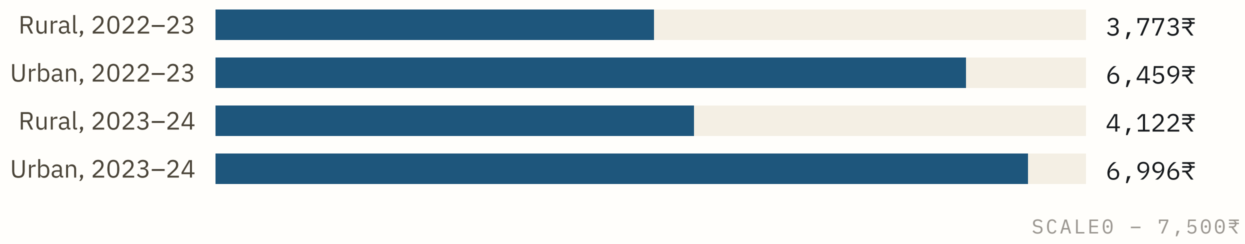
Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 4.5 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 4.5 RANKED BARS

Household consumption expenditure (MPCE)

Monthly per capita consumption expenditure, rural and urban, across the two most recent HCES rounds.



Source: Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES), MoSPI

MPCE is the bridge between GDP growth and how households actually live — it is the base data used to estimate poverty and inequality. The urban-rural gap (roughly 70%) has narrowed only slightly across the two rounds.

Source: Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES), MoSPI Coverage: 2022–23 to 2023–24

Updated: 18 Aug 2026

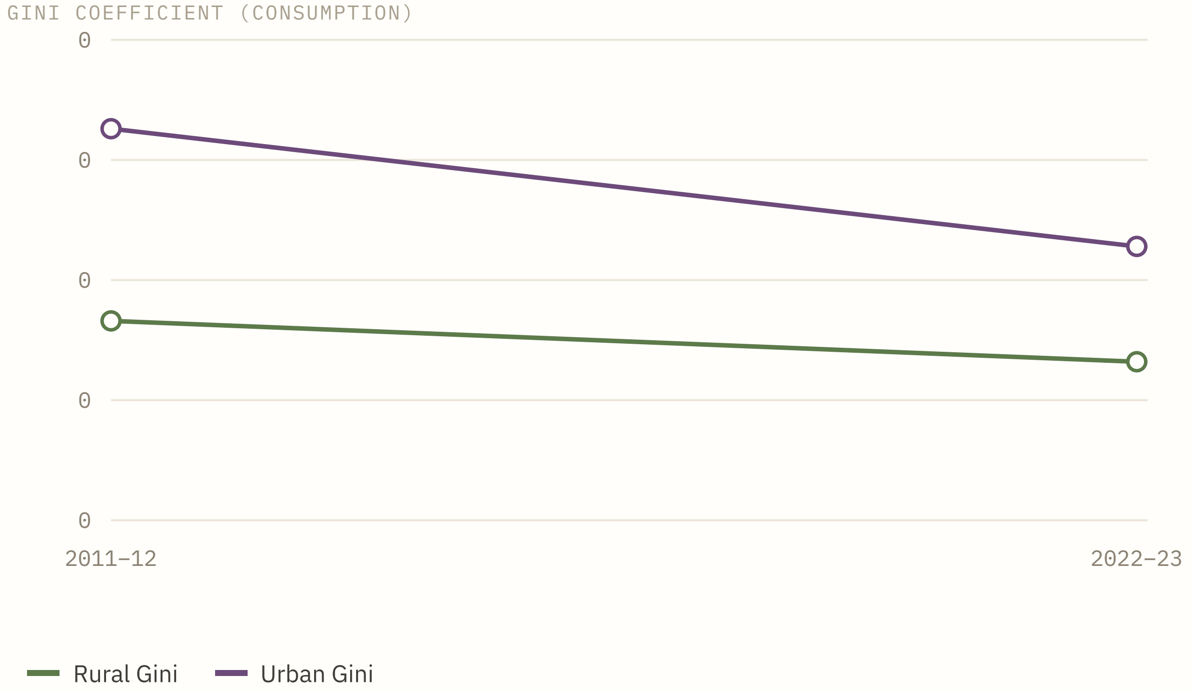
FIGURE 4.6 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 4.6

SLOPE CHART

Consumption inequality (Gini)

Gini coefficient of consumption expenditure, rural and urban.



Consumption inequality fell in both rural and urban India between the two HCES rounds, though urban India remains meaningfully more unequal than rural India by this measure. Consumption-based Gini typically reads lower than income-based Gini for the same population.

Source: HCES-derived Gini estimates, MoSPI

Both rural and urban inequality fell between the two survey rounds. Consumption-based Gini is structurally lower than income-based Gini for the same population, since consumption smooths over income volatility — comparisons with countries that report income Gini should account for this.

Source: HCES-derived Gini estimates, MoSPI Coverage: 2011–12 to 2022–23 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

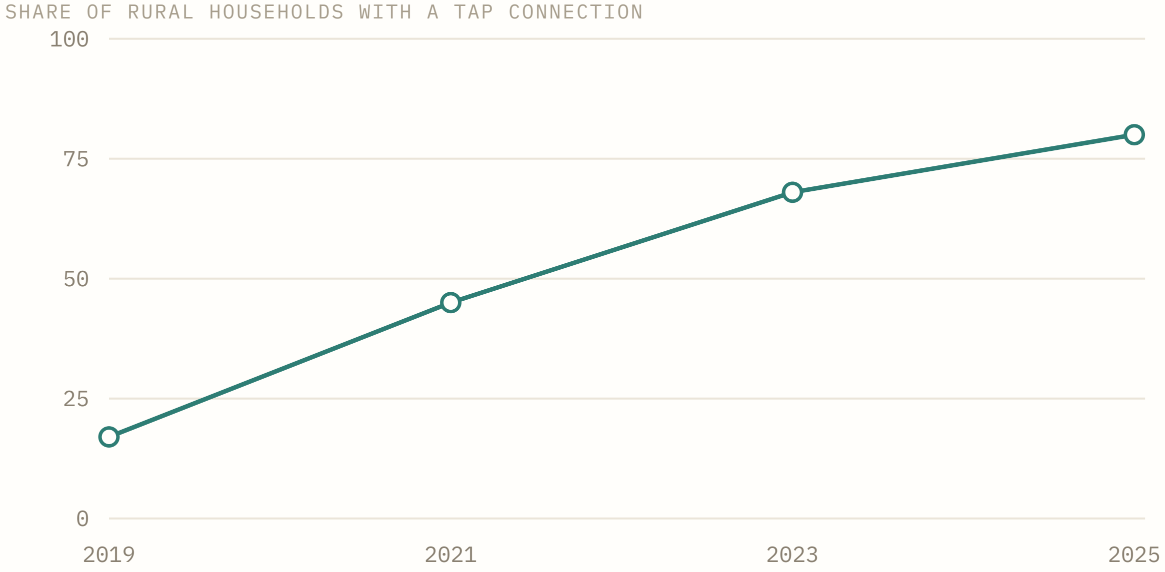
FIGURE 4.7 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 4.7

LINE CHART

Rural tap water access

Share of rural households with a functional tap water connection under the Jal Jeevan Mission.



> The Jal Jeevan Mission (launched 2019) targets universal rural tap water; coverage more than quadrupled in its first four years, one of the fastest infrastructure rollouts in this dataset. “Tap connection” does not guarantee daily or potable supply — functionality audits report a materially lower share of connections working reliably.

Source: Jal Jeevan Mission dashboard, Ministry of Jal Shakti

Coverage rose from under a fifth of rural households in 2019 to roughly four-fifths by 2025, one of the fastest rural infrastructure rollouts in this dataset. A reported connection does not guarantee daily supply or potability — independent functionality audits typically report a lower working share.

Source: Jal Jeevan Mission dashboard, Ministry of Jal Shakti Coverage: 2019–2025 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

CHAPTER 5

Employment & labour

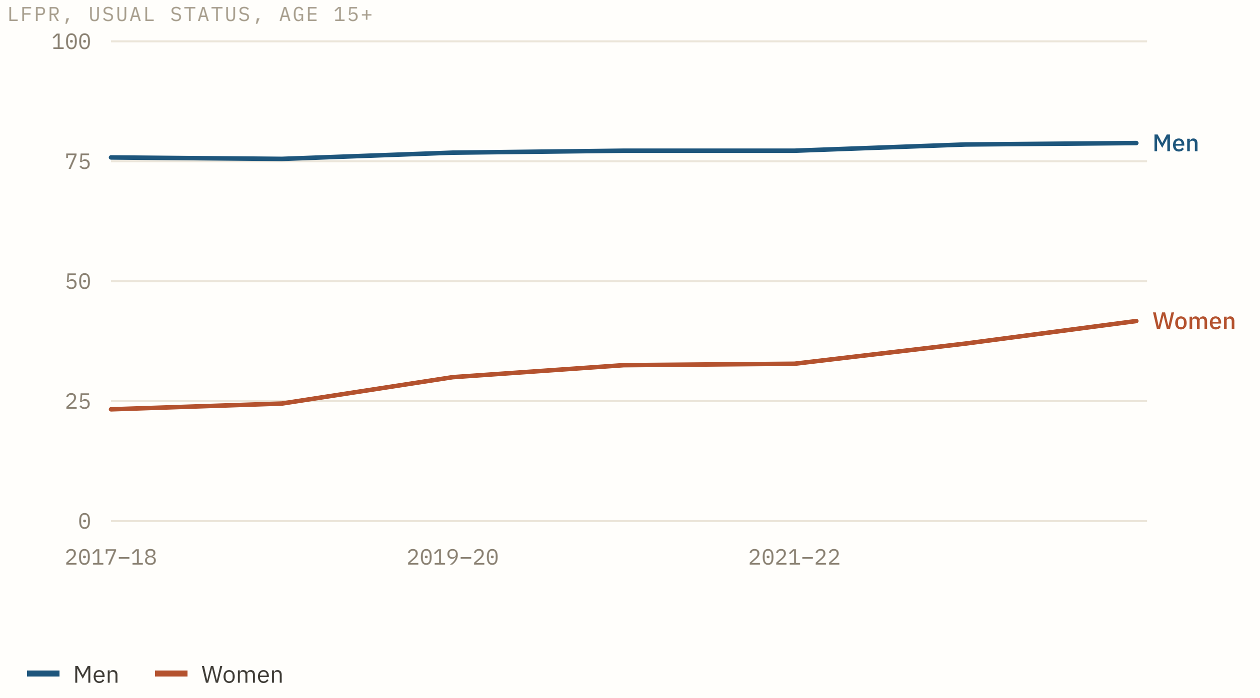
2 of 3 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 5.1 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 5.1 LINE CHART

Labour force participation by sex

Usual status participation rate for people aged 15 and above.



Source: PLFS Annual Report 2023–24, MoSPI

Female participation has risen sharply since 2018 on the PLFS usual-status definition, but most of the increase is in unpaid work on family farms and enterprises. Salaried employment for women has grown far more slowly.

Source: PLFS Annual Report 2023–24, MoSPI Coverage: 2017–2024 Updated: 21 Jul 2026

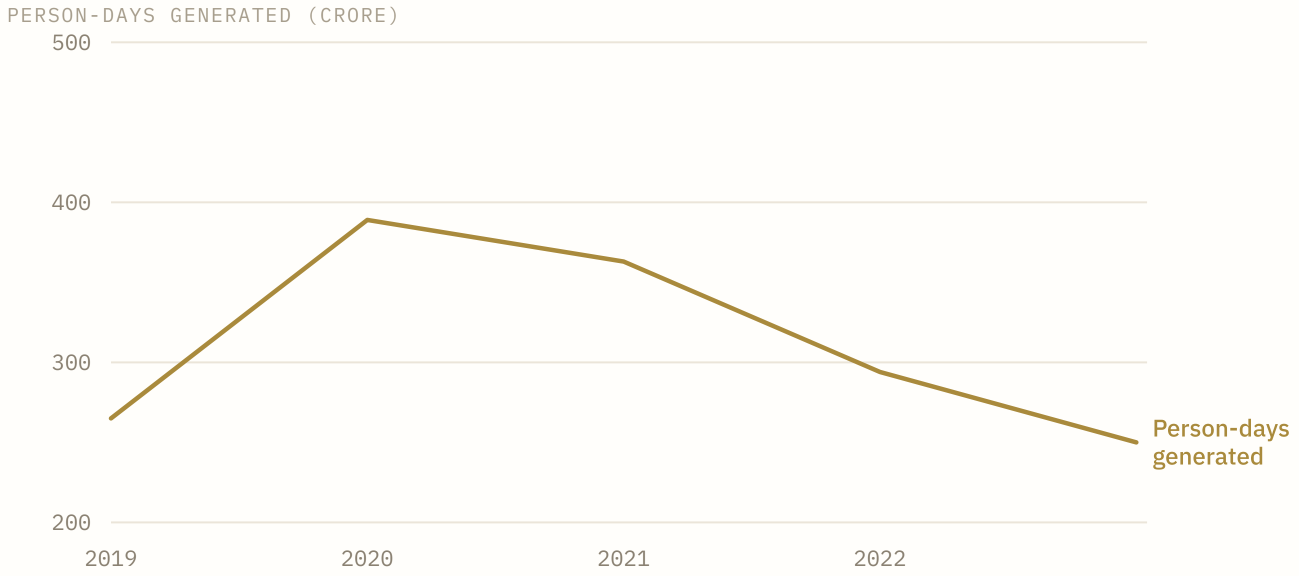
FIGURE 5.2 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 5.2

LINE CHART

MGNREGA employment generated

Person-days of work generated annually under the rural employment guarantee scheme.



The 2020–21 spike reflects reverse migration and urban job losses during the pandemic; demand has eased since but stayed above pre-pandemic levels.

Source: MGNREGA MIS, Ministry of Rural Development

The scheme acts as an automatic stabiliser: person-days jumped 47% in 2020–21 as migrant workers returned to villages during the pandemic, then eased as urban labour markets recovered.

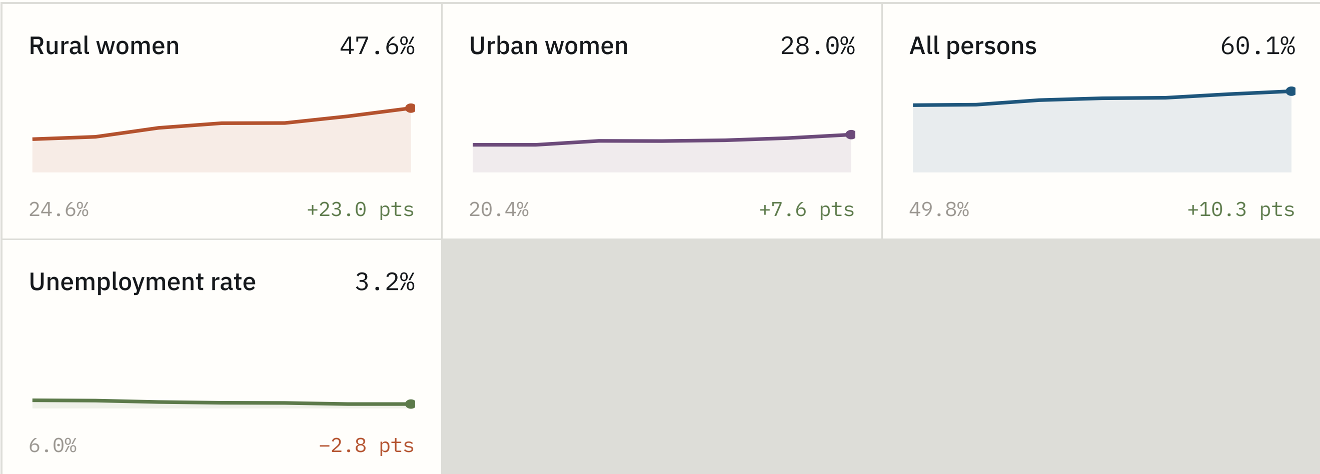
Source: MGNREGA MIS, Ministry of Rural Development Coverage: 2019–20 to 2023–24 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 5.3 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 5.3 SMALL MULTIPLES

Labour force participation — small multiples

Four series on one shared 0–65% scale, so the panels can be compared directly.



2017–18 → 2023–24, EACH PANEL ON THE SAME 0–65 % SCALE

> Same scale in every panel, so the panels are directly comparable. Rural women drive almost the whole national increase.

Source: PLFS Annual Reports 2017–18 to 2023–24, MoSPI

Rural women account for almost the entire national increase: their LFPR nearly doubled from 24.6% to 47.6%, while urban women moved from 20.4% to 28.0%. Part of the change is measurement — PLFS probes unpaid work in family enterprises more carefully than the surveys it replaced.

Source: PLFS Annual Reports 2017–18 to 2023–24, MoSPI Coverage: 2017–18 to 2023–24 Updated: 21 Jul 2026

CHAPTER 6

Gender

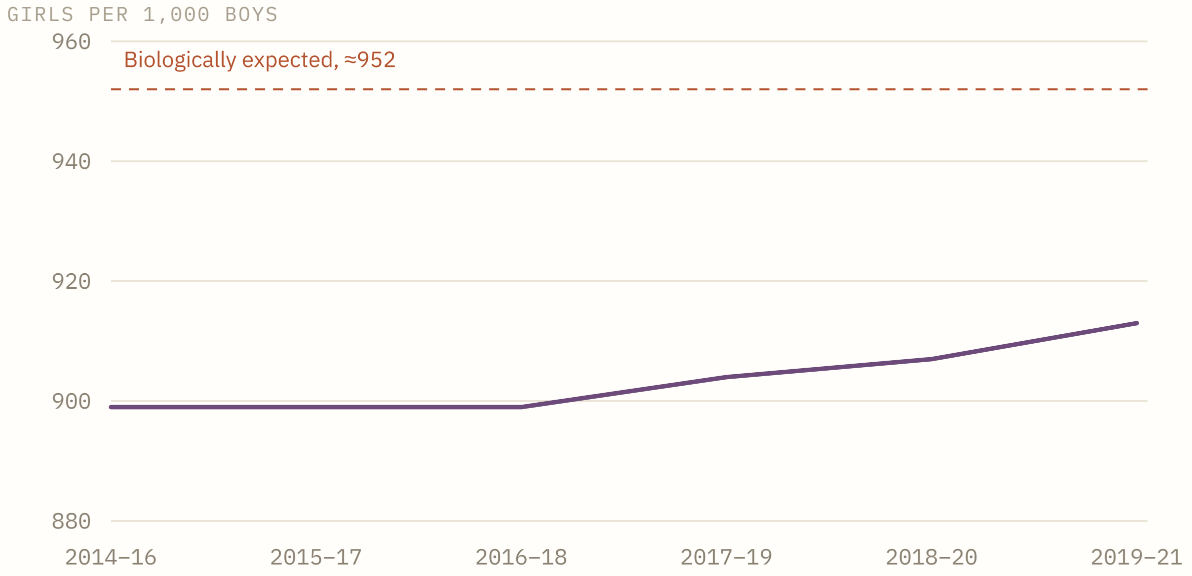
2 of 4 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 6.1 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 6.1 LINE CHART

Sex ratio at birth

Girls born per 1,000 boys. A biologically typical value is about 950.



Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI

The ratio fell through the 1990s as ultrasound diagnosis spread, bottomed around 2011, and has partially recovered. Recovery is concentrated in Punjab, Haryana and Himachal Pradesh — the states where the deficit was worst.

Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI   Coverage: 1991–2023   Updated: 21 Jul 2026

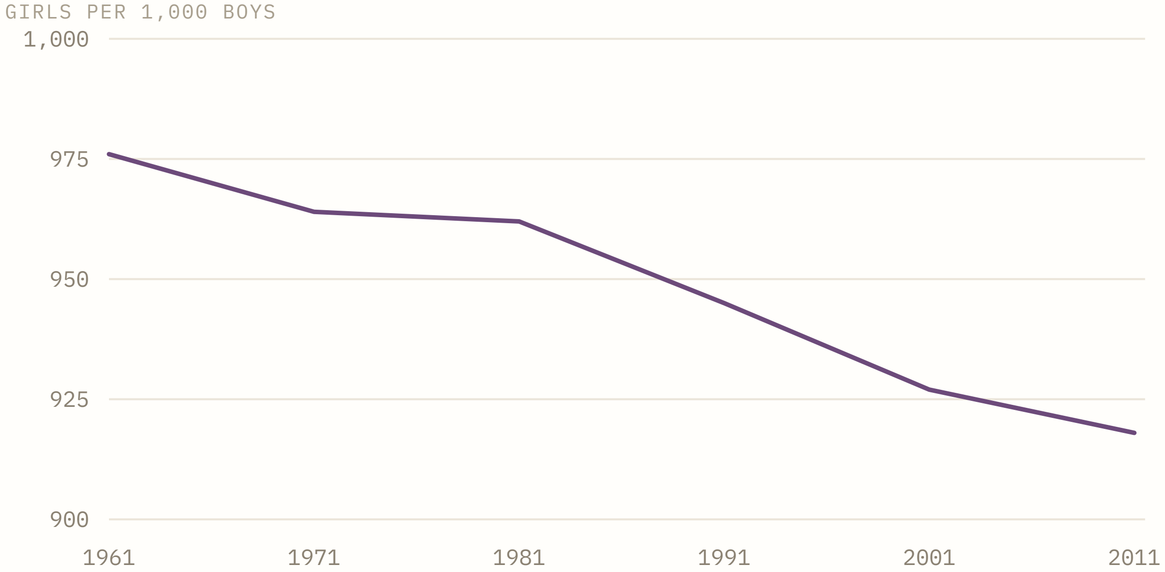
FIGURE 6.2 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 6.2

LINE CHART

Child sex ratio, 0–6 years

Girls per 1,000 boys among children aged 0 to 6, by Census round.



Source: Census of India, decennial rounds

The child sex ratio fell in every round from 1961 to 2011, most sharply in the 1990s as ultrasound diagnosis spread. Unlike the sex ratio at birth, it also absorbs excess female mortality in early childhood.

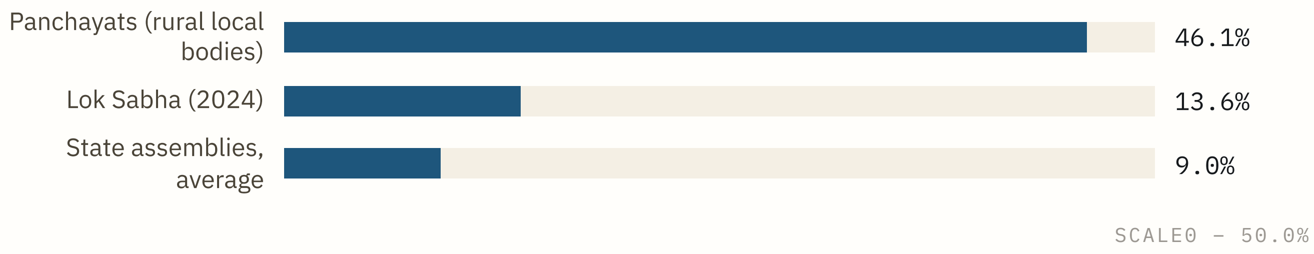
Source: Census of India, decennial rounds Coverage: 1961–2011 Updated: 11 Jan 2026

FIGURE 6.3 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 6.3 RANKED BARS

Women’s political representation

Women’s seat share across three tiers of elected government.



Source: Election Commission of India; Ministry of Panchayati Raj

Constitutional reservation (33–50% depending on state) drives the far higher Panchayat figure; no equivalent reservation exists yet for the Lok Sabha or most state assemblies, though a Women’s Reservation Act passed in 2023 is due to apply from the next delimitation.

Source: Election Commission of India; Ministry of Panchayati Raj Coverage: 2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 6.4 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 6.4 RANKED BARS

Gender wage gap

Average female daily wage as a percentage of the average male daily wage, by employment type.

Source: PLFS Annual Report, MoSPI

The gap has narrowed slowly over the past decade but persists across both casual and regular/salaried work, even after accounting for differences in sector and hours — unexplained gaps of this kind are consistent with occupational segregation and direct wage discrimination.

Source: PLFS Annual Report, MoSPI Coverage: 2023–24 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

CHAPTER 7

Urban development & housing

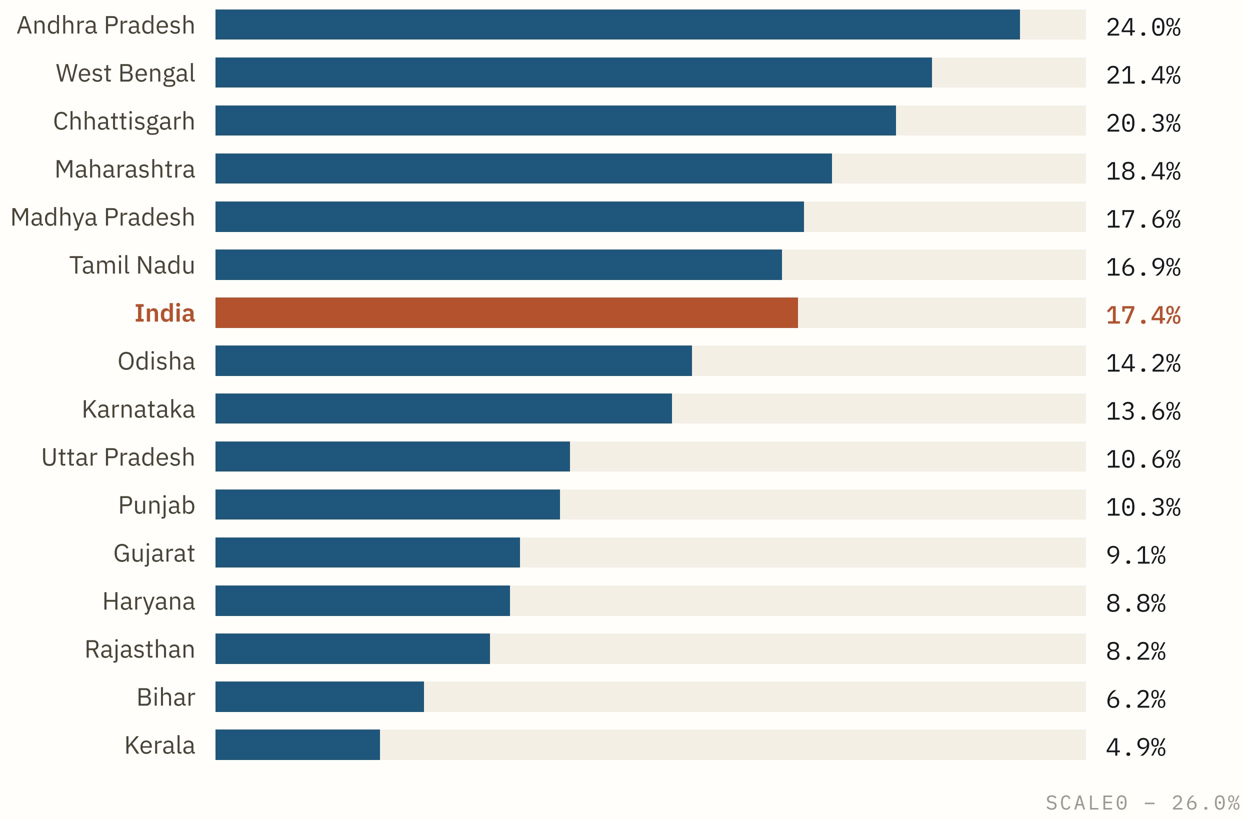
1 of 7 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 7.1 NATIONAL + STATE

FIGURE 7.1 RANKED BARS

Slum population share by state

Share of a state's urban population enumerated in Census-notified or recognised slums.



Source: Census of India 2011, Primary Census Abstract for Slum

This is the last Census-based slum count available — no Census has been held since 2011, so growth in informal settlements over the past decade is not captured here. Definitions vary by state (notified, recognised and identified slums), which limits strict comparability.

> Highest: **Andhra Pradesh** at 24.0%. Lowest: **Kerala** at 4.9%.

Source: Census of India 2011, Primary Census Abstract for Slum Coverage: 2011 Updated: 11 Jan 2026

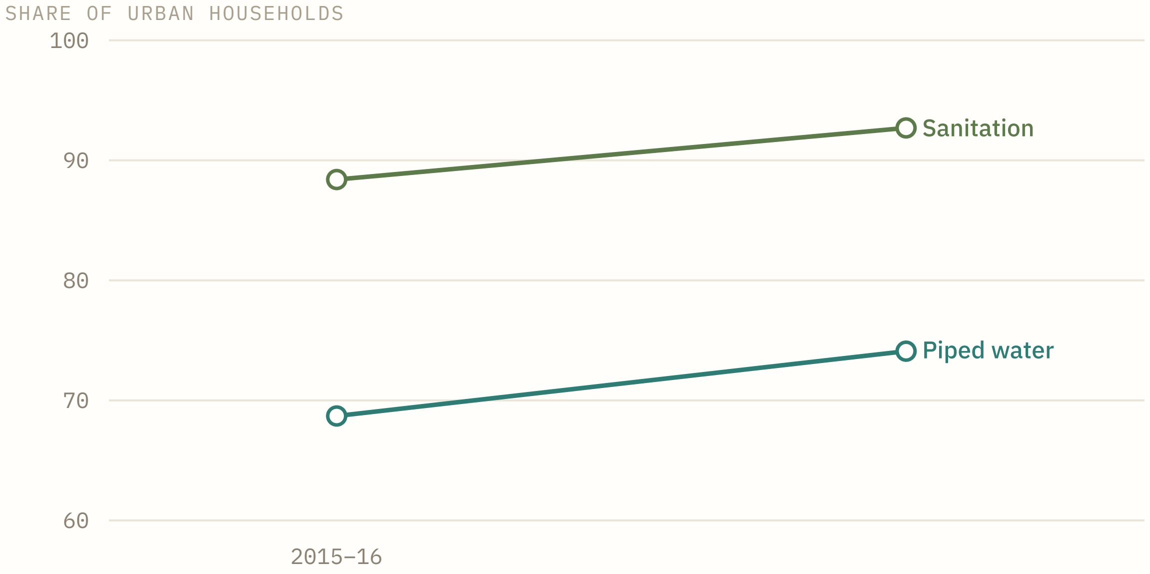
FIGURE 7.2 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 7.2

SLOPE CHART

Urban piped water and sanitation access

Share of urban households with piped water on premises, and with improved, unshared sanitation.



Piped water on premises — Improved, unshared sanitation

> Both measures rose over the two NFHS rounds, with the Swachh Bharat Mission’s urban push likely behind most of the sanitation gain. “Piped on premises” excludes households relying on public taps or tankers even where those are the piped source.

Source: NFHS-4 and NFHS-5, MoHFW

Both series improved between NFHS rounds. “Piped on premises” is stricter than “access to an improved water source” — it excludes households that rely on public taps, tankers or neighbours’ connections even if the underlying source is piped.

Source: NFHS-4 and NFHS-5, MoHFW Coverage: 2015–16 to 2019–21 Updated: 11 Jan 2026

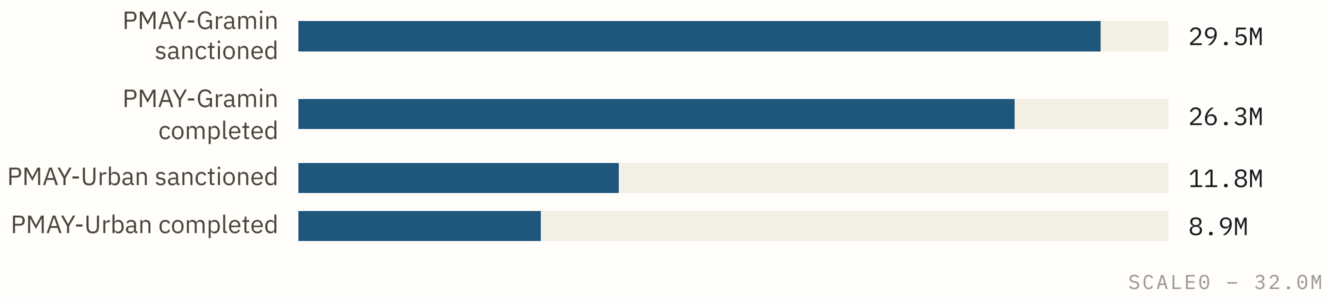
FIGURE 7.3 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 7.3

RANKED BARS

PMAY housing progress

Houses sanctioned versus completed under the rural and urban Housing for All schemes.



Source: Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana dashboards, MoHUA & MoRD

The rural scheme (PMAY-Gramin) is closer to its sanctioned target than the urban scheme (PMAY-Urban), where land acquisition and construction timelines run longer. “Completed” means handed over to the beneficiary, not merely under construction.

Source: Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana dashboards, MoHUA & MoRD Coverage: Cumulative to 2025 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

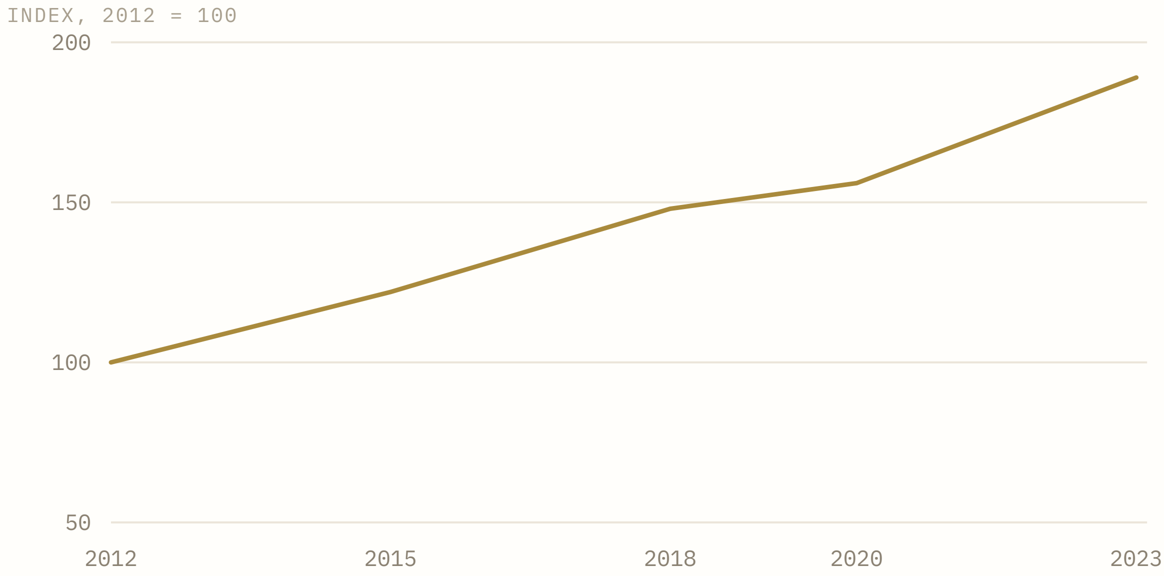
FIGURE 7.4 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 7.4

LINE CHART

Night-time light intensity

Indexed satellite-measured night-time light intensity, a proxy for economic and urban activity.



> Indexed from satellite VIIRS-DNB night-time light composites, a widely used proxy for regional economic activity where official sub-national GDP data lags or is unavailable. This is a research-derived composite, not an official government statistic — treat the trend as indicative rather than precise.

Source: VIIRS-DNB satellite composites, research literature

Night-time lights are used by researchers as a fast, sub-national proxy for economic growth where official data is thin or delayed. It captures electrified activity, not output directly, so it can overstate growth in areas that simply gained grid access rather than economic output.

Source: VIIRS-DNB satellite composites, research literature Coverage: 2012–2023 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

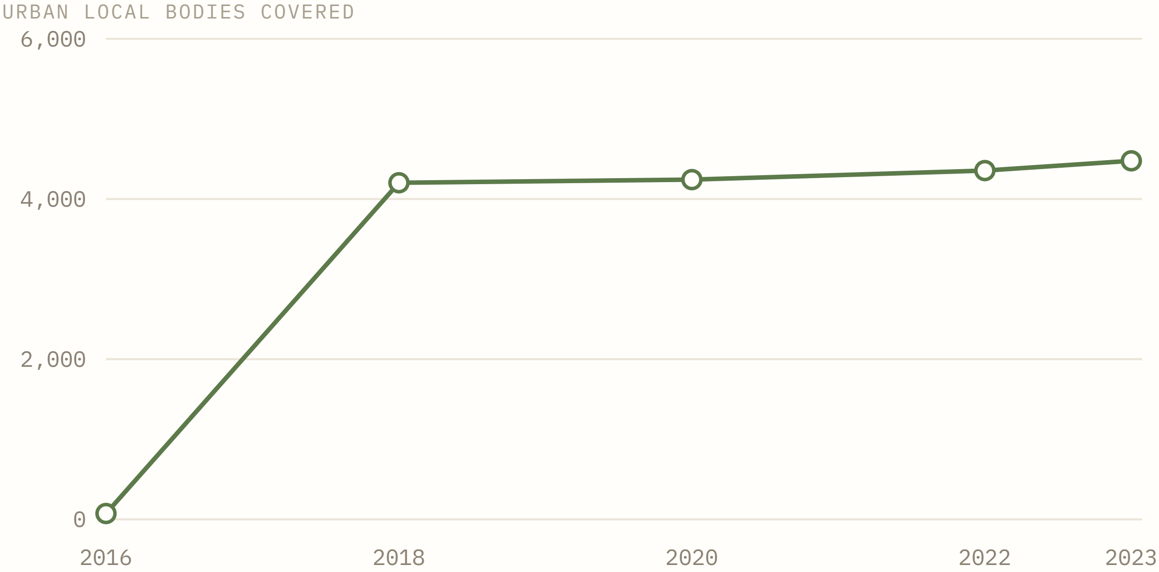
FIGURE 7.5 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 7.5

LINE CHART

Swachh Survekshan coverage

Number of cities and urban local bodies covered by India’s annual cleanliness survey.



> Swachh Survekshan grew from 73 cities in its first edition to nearly every urban local body in the country within a decade, making it the world’s largest urban cleanliness survey by participant count. Coverage growth, not score, is shown here — city rankings and scoring methodology have both changed across editions, which limits year-on-year score comparability.

Source: Swachh Survekshan, MoHUA

The survey has become close to universal across urban India, which is itself a policy achievement independent of any city’s score. Scoring methodology and weightings have changed across editions, so a city’s rank in different years is not a clean apples-to-apples comparison.

Source: Swachh Survekshan, MoHUA Coverage: 2016–2023 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 7.6 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 7.6

RANKED BARS

AMRUT water and sewerage connections

Household tap and sewer/septage connections provided under AMRUT's first phase.

Source: Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation, MoHUA

AMRUT 1.0 fell short of its full connection targets by its 2021 close; AMRUT 2.0 (launched 2021) aims at universal coverage. Sewerage lagged water supply throughout the scheme, reflecting the higher cost and longer build time of underground network projects.

Source: Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation, MoHUA Coverage: 2015–2021 (AMRUT 1.0)

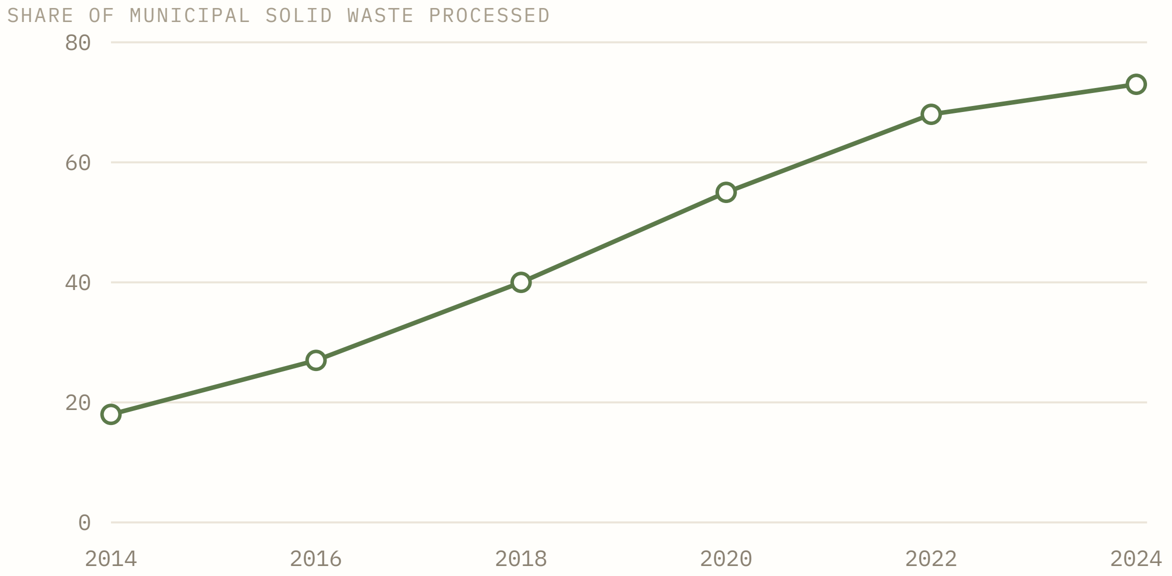
Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 7.7 NATIONAL ONLY

FIGURE 7.7 LINE CHART

Municipal solid waste processing

Share of India's municipal solid waste that is scientifically processed rather than dumped.



> Processing capacity has grown roughly fourfold under the Swachh Bharat Mission, though this tracks capacity utilisation rather than a direct daily audit — actual processing rates vary widely by city, and total waste generation has also grown as urban population and consumption rose.

Source: Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban dashboard, MoHUA

Processing capacity has grown roughly fourfold since 2014, but total waste generation has also risen with urban population and consumption growth — a rising processed share does not necessarily mean a falling absolute quantity dumped in landfills.

Source: Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban dashboard, MoHUA Coverage: 2014–2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

Methodology and limitations

Every figure in this report is reproduced from a published source without adjustment. India Insight Lab does not estimate, model or interpolate the values shown. Each chart carries the source it came from, the years it covers and the date the series was last updated.

Three limitations apply to everything above, and are stated rather than worked around:

- **Geographic depth.** Indicators reach national and, for 18 of 39 series, state level. District and city figures are not included because comparable data is not yet integrated.
- **Comparability across sources.** Series drawn from different sources use different definitions, reference periods and sampling designs. They are shown side by side but are not adjusted onto a common basis.
- **Currency.** Update dates vary by series; the most recent revision date is shown beneath each figure. Some official series lag by several years.

> **Nothing in this report is projected.** Where a series ends, the report ends with it. No forecast, scenario or extrapolation has been added to extend a trend beyond its published data.

References

33 sources used in this report.

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9	Census of India; UN World Urbanization Prospects
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13	Jal Jeevan Mission dashboard, Ministry of Jal Shakti
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32	VIIRS-DNB satellite composites, research literature
33	World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief, India (2025)

Source URLs, licence terms and retrieval dates are not yet recorded for every series. Adding them is scheduled work, and until it is done these references name the publication rather than link to it.